

TizenZen

A calm, ad-free home screen for Samsung TVs. Your AI assistant installs it in minutes.

Guide for people and for AI assistants

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FOR PEOPLE

What you get

TizenZen replaces what you see on your Samsung TV with a clock, the weather where you live, your apps, and slow aerial video. No ads, no tracking, nothing to sign in to.



On the screen

- Clock and date
- Weather today, and the next seven days
- Your app tiles
- Sources, Apps and Settings
- Aerial video in the background (yellow button: on/off)
- Darker and warmer after sunset

It comes back by itself

- When you turn the TV on
- When you close an app
- When you leave a console on HDMI (Back)

It does not

- Root, flash or change the TV
- Need an account
- Collect anything

FOR PEOPLE

Installing it

You need a computer on the same network as the TV, and an AI coding assistant such as Claude Code.

1. Ask your assistant

> Set up TizenZen on my Samsung TV: github.com/<owner>/tizenzen. Follow AGENTS.md.

2. Turn on Developer Mode (with the remote)

1. Open **Apps** and type **1 2 3 4 5**.
2. Switch Developer mode **On**; type in the computer's address (your assistant tells you which).
3. Unplug the TV for 30 seconds.

3. Let it work

The assistant downloads Samsung's tools, installs TizenZen and tests it. It may ask you to press **Power** once, or to allow a popup on the TV.

Good to know

- **Home inside YouTube** still shows Samsung's bar. Hold **Back** for two seconds instead: YouTube closes and TizenZen returns.
- To delete apps you never use: Home → Apps → gear → app → Delete.
- Faster TV for free: hold Power until the logo shows (a real restart), run Device Care, and turn off Viewing Information Services and Interest-Based Ads.
- A phone camera pointed at the TV lets the assistant see the screen if something only shows there.

FOR CLAUDE

Where the obvious idea fails

Thirteen pitfalls, found on a 2020 Tizen 5.5 TV. Full details and checks in docs/PITFALLS.md.

PITFALL	WHAT TO DO
Home can't be replaced	Background service reopens TizenZen when covered.
Home inside YouTube	Undetectable (overlay). Long-press Back works.
Two ids per app	Open by Tizen id, watch by Smart Hub id (YouTube `111299001912`).
System screens blocked	Settings/Source/Apps can't be launched by an app. Own pickers + key helper.
Slow power-on	Detect wake by the timer gap; launch at once, not via the network API.
Watcher steals slow apps	6 s grace before reclaiming; `selftest.sh` catches it.
HDMI object	Pass the TV's own VIDEOSOURCE object; list "disconnected" ports too.
Video stuck after apps	New <video> element on every return; 30 s watchdog.
No uninstall	`vd_appuninstall` refused; the person deletes on the TV.
No pairing popup	Device Connection Manager; tokens only work from the machine that paired.
Developer Mode	Host IP = interface that reaches the TV; unplug to apply.
Newer TVs	May need a Samsung developer certificate (see AeroTizen).
Dead ends	Wake-on-LAN, service menus, port 8001 websocket.

FOR CLAUDE

Working like a coworker

Test yourself, look yourself, and ask the person only for what needs hands.

`tools/find-tv.sh` find the TV, Developer Mode state

`TV_IP=… tools/deploy.sh` package, install, start

`TV_IP=… tools/selftest.sh 111299001912` open/close apps, expect PASS

`TV_IP=… tools/status.sh` the watcher's log of every decision

`TV_IP=… python3 tools/tvkey.py HOLD:KEY_RETURN:2000` remote keys

When you are stuck

- Read the log first: app errors show up there as `app: …`.
- If only the screen can tell (a popup, a black picture), offer the camera: an iPhone next to a Mac works as a webcam; `tools/camera-snap.sh` takes a photo. Check the first photo shows the whole screen.
- The network can't turn the screen on from deep standby. Ask the person to press Power once, then read the log.
- Never remove system packages. Never commit `config.local.js` or the token.

Before you finish

- Tell the person plainly what works and the limits.
- Offer to remove the Tizen tools (~600 MB).
- Add the TV to docs/MODELS.md.